

Ohio Auto Insurance Regulatory Compendium

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Purpose: A consolidated, expanded regulatory reference for Meridian Mutual's Personal Auto line, drawing together and extending the topic-specific regulatory references elsewhere in this corpus.

Effective: January 1, 2025

This document is a synthetic reference prepared for a software assessment corpus. It is presented for realism and internal consistency with this corpus only and should not be relied on as current legal advice.

1. Financial Responsibility

Ohio requires liability insurance no less than \$25,000 per person / \$50,000 per accident bodily injury and \$25,000 property damage, as summarized in the Ohio Regulatory Reference. All policyholders in this corpus carry limits at or above this minimum; see each policyholder's Declarations page.

2. Uninsured and Underinsured Motorist Coverage

Ohio insurers are not required to include UM/UIM coverage automatically but must offer it in writing; a policyholder may reject it in writing. Every policyholder in this corpus has elected UM/UIM coverage. The Uninsured Motorist Property Damage Endorsement (END-UMPD-01) is a separate, optional extension beyond the bodily-injury-focused UM/UIM coverage in Policy Wording Part C.

3. Claims-Handling Timelines

3.1 Acknowledgment

10 business days under PAP-2025-STD, 15 under PAP-2024-STD, per Policy Wording Section 8.1 and the Ohio Regulatory Reference — extendable by up to 5 additional business days during a declared catastrophe event per the Catastrophe Claims Surge Protocol.

3.2 Investigation and Decision

An insurer should begin investigation within 15 business days of acknowledgment and communicate a coverage decision within 30 calendar days of completing investigation, per the Ohio Regulatory Reference, Section 2.

3.3 Payment After a Decision

An undisputed claim is paid within 10 business days of the coverage decision.

4. Unfair Claims Settlement Practices

Ohio prohibits a defined set of unfair claims settlement practices, detailed in the Ohio Unfair Claims Settlement Practices Reference, including misrepresenting policy provisions, failing to acknowledge claims promptly, denying a claim without reasonable investigation, and failing to explain a denial in writing with the specific policy provision relied upon.

5. Total Loss and Salvage Title

A vehicle for which a total loss claim is paid must be branded with a salvage title unless repaired to a roadworthy standard before resale, per the Ohio Total Loss and Salvage Title Requirements. The insurer must notify the state title office within 5 business days of a total loss settlement.

6. Data Privacy

While not exclusively an insurance-specific requirement, an insurer handling policyholder and claimant PII is expected to apply minimum-necessary access principles and document what data leaves its infrastructure to any third party, including a hosted AI service — see the Data Privacy and PII Handling Policy.

7. Producer (Agent) Conduct

A producer's binding authority, and the underwriting referral triggers that limit it, are documented in the Producer Manual Excerpt. Ohio requires a licensed producer for any binding transaction; this compendium does not restate licensing requirements themselves, which are administered separately from claims and coverage.

8. Relationship Between This Compendium and Topic-Specific References

This compendium is a navigation aid across the corpus's regulatory-adjacent documents; where a topic-specific document (the Ohio Regulatory Reference, the Ohio Total Loss and Salvage Title Requirements, or the Ohio Unfair Claims

Settlement Practices Reference) provides more detail than this summary, that document controls.